

(b) Island groups of the Arabian Sea

*In Lakshadweep, near the Malabar coast lies an archipelago of 12 atolls, 3 reefs and 5 submerged banks with about 36 islands and islets. The name of this archipelago was changed to Lakshadweep in **1973**, earlier it was known as the **Laccadive**, **Minicoy** and **Aminidivi Islands**. The distance of the Lakshadweep Islands from the state of Kerala (Kochi) varies from about 220-440 km. Lakshadweep is a Union Territory with a total area of 32 persons/sq. km. *There are **36** islands in the Lakshadweep Island group.

*The northernmost inhabited island of Lakshadweep is called **Chetlat** whereas the southern end is called **Minicoy**. Minicoy island is separated from the rest of the islands by **9° channels**. *Minicoy is the **2nd largest island** (4.80 person/sq. km) of Lakshadweep. ***Kavaratti** is the capital of Lakshadweep, located on the Kavaratti Island. The largest island of Lakshadweep is **Andrott** or **Androth** (4.90 km²). The Elephanta island is located near Mumbai about 10 km from the Gateway of India. ***Salsette island** is in the state of Maharashtra on India's west coast. The metropolis of Mumbai and the city of Thane lie on it.

*Offshore Island - from the deltaic regions of the Ganga to the Eastern and Western coasts of India, to Gulf of Mannar, many islands are located. Among these are **Piram** (Gulf of Khambhat), **Bhainsala** (Kathiawar), **Diu**, **Baida**, **Nora**, **Pirotan**, **Karunbhar** (Kutch), **Khadiya Bet** : Elyabet (near the Mouth of the Narmada & Tapti rivers), **Butcher (Jawahar Dweep)**, **Karanja (Uran)**, **Cross** (near Mumbai), **Bhatkal**, **Pigeon**, **Saint Mary** (near Mangalore), **Anjediva** (near Karwar Coast), **Vypeen** (near Kochi), **Shrot**, **Wheeler** (near the mouth of the Mahanadi & Brahmani rivers), **New Moore & Ganga Sagar** (in Ganga Deltaic region) are some prominent ones. ***Kori creek** and **Niveshika** are tidal creeks. **Sir Creek** is a **96 km** long tidal estuary in the Rann of Kutch region. It lies on the border of India and Pakistan and has been a disputed area between the two nations. It separates Gujarat from the Sindh province of Pakistan. The dispute lies in the interpretation of the maritime boundary line between India and Pakistan. At present the area is under the possession of India.

1. Where is Lakshadweep located?

- (a) Indian Ocean
- (b) Arabian Sea
- (c) Bay of Bengal
- (d) Pacific Ocean

M.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 1990

Ans. (b)

Lakshadweep is a group of islands in the Arabian sea. The entire island group is built of coral deposits. There are 36 islands in the Lakshadweep island group. Minicoy is the second largest island separated from other islands by 9° Channel. Kavaratti is the capital of Lakshadweep. The largest island of Lakshadweep is Andrott. These islands are located at a distance of 220 - 440 km off the Kerala coast.

2. Consider the following statements about Lakshadweep islands.

- 1. This group of islands is composed of small coral islands.
- 2. Earlier they were known as Laccadive, Minicoy and Amindive.
- 3. Islands group lying close to the Coramandel Coast of Tamil Nadu.

Which of the statements given above is/are correct?

- (a) Only 1
- (b) Only 1 and 2
- (c) Only 3
- (d) None of the above

Chhattisgarh P.C.S. (Pre) 2023

Ans. (b)

Lakshadweep, the group of 36 islands is known for its exotic and Sun-kissed beaches and lush green landscape. The name Lashadweep in Malayalam and Sanskrit means 'A hundred thousand island'. Lakshadweep islands group lies close to the Malabar coast of Kerala. Hence statement (3) is wrong. This group of islands is composed of small coral islands. Earlier they were known as Laccadive, Minicoy and Amindive. In 1973 these were renamed as Lakshadweep. Kavaratti island is the administrative headquarters of Lakshadweep. The Islands have a total area of 32 sq. km.

3. Which of the following Island is not a part of Laccadive Island?

- (a) Tilanchong
- (b) Agathi
- (c) Kavaratti
- (d) Kalpeni

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (a)

Tilanchong is a part of the Andaman and Nicobar Islands. All the remaining islands are part of the Laccadive (Lakshadweep) archipelago.

4. In which of the following parts of India 'Atolls' are commonly found?

- (a) Near Sunderbans
- (b) Near Khambhat Gulf
- (c) Near Lakshadweep
- (d) Near Rameshwaram

Jharkhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2021

Ans. (c)

'Atolls' are commonly found near Lakshadweep.

5. Which of the following is a coral island ?

- (a) New Moore
- (b) Car Nicobar
- (c) Andaman
- (d) Lakshadweep

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (d)

Lakshadweep is a coral island located in the Arabian Sea and its capital is Kavaratti. It is located in south west of India.

6. Lakshadweep island is situated –

- (a) In South west India
- (b) In South India
- (c) In South east India
- (d) In East India near West Bengal

38th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1992

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

7. Lakshadweep consists of how many Islands?

- (a) 17
- (b) 27
- (c) 36
- (d) 47

45th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2001

Ans. (c)

There are 36 islands in the Lakshadweep island group.

8. Islands group Lakshadweep is -

- (a) Accumulation of coral reef
- (b) Accumulation of volcano substances
- (c) Soil sedimentation
- (d) None of the above-mentioned is true

39th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 1994

Ans. (a)

Lakshadweep group of islands is on accumulation of coral reef. Coral reefs in India are found in Andaman and Nicobar islands, Gulf of Mannar, Lakshadweep, Malvan (Maharashtra) and Gulf of Kutch.

9. Coral reefs are not found in which one of the following regions?

- (a) Gulf of Cambay
- (b) Gulf of Mannar
- (c) Gulf of Kutch
- (d) Lakshadweep and Minicoy Island
- (e) None of the above / More than one of the above

65th B.P.S.C. (Pre) 2019

Ans. (a)

See the explanation of the above question.

10. Which one of the following is one of the remotest islands from Indian coast ?

- (a) Bhatkal
- (b) Arnala
- (c) Minicoy
- (d) Henry

U.P.U.D.A./L.D.A. (Pre) 2013

Ans. (c)

Among the given options, Minicoy is one of the remotest islands from Indian Coast. Bhatkal, Arnala, and Henry come in the category of offshore islands.

11. Which one of the following Indian Island lies between India and Sri Lanka ?

- (a) Elephanta
- (b) Nicobar
- (c) Rameswaram
- (d) Salsette

Uttarakhand P.C.S. (Pre) 2010

U.P.P.C.S. (Pre) 2006

Ans. (c)

The location of islands given in the options is as follows :

Elephanta Island : It is located at a distance of about 10 kilometers from the Gateway of India (Mumbai).

Nicobar Island : It is located in southeast of Bay of Bengal between 6° -12° North latitude and 92°-94° East Longitude. It consists of 22 main islands.

Rameswaram Island: Rameswaram is located in the Ramanathapuram district of Tamil Nadu. It lies between India and Sri Lanka.

Salsette Island : It is an island in the Maharashtra state of India. The metropolis of Mumbai and the city of Thane are located here making it one of the most densely populated islands of India.

12. A large city built on an Indian island is –

- (a) Panaji
- (b) Rameswaram
- (c) Port Blair
- (d) Mumbai

R.A.S./R.T.S. (Pre) 1993

Ans. (d)

India's largest city on an island is Mumbai. The total area of Port Blair is greater than that of Mumbai however from township perspective, it is lesser.

13. The most populous island of India is:

- (a) Majuli
- (b) Andaman
- (c) Lakshadweep
- (d) Salsette

U.P. P.C.S. (Mains) 2016

Ans. (d)

India's most populous island is Salsette Island, on which the city of Mumbai and Thane district are situated.